

For optimising telecom applications, even professionals with science and engineering background often require specialised training

—K.S. Mittal, director-project, Mobile Communication (India)



new staff in a project with minimum domain-specific training.

Says Loganathan V., vice president, ISM, a Bangalore-based reputed training Institute, "We provide finishing touch to engineers on their practical skills."

Focus areas for training

During the past three months amid this recession, whenever I found a ray of hope in the Indian electronics industry it invariably had to do something with the word 'telecom.' If there is one sector which is showing tremendous growth, and will continue to expand, it is telecom. This is clearly corroborated by the fact that India is currently adding 8-10 million mobile subscribers every month. Given the huge size of the nation and the fact that only 25 per cent of the population has communication network now, the future looks bright.

"Considering that telecom is a booming sector even in times like the current economic recession, the demand for employable individuals is quite high. And in this regard, the types of firms that engage in recruiting are spread across operators, integrators and vendors," reveals Pius Maria Prasad, director-human resource, Huawei Technologies India. This huge manpower need can be addressed only by an extensive training network throughout the country.

"For optimising telecom applications, even professionals with science and engineering background often require specialised training in theory and practice in order to properly handle different types of machines and instru-

ments in various systems of telecom equipment, both in wired and wireless communication," says, K.S. Mittal, director-projects, Mobile Communication (India).

The niche skill sets required are 3G and other advanced mobile technologies, mobile repairing techniques and networking.

Another sector that is likely to benefit from the current recession is automation. As corporate majors look to cut costs and increase productivity, one way they are likely to achieve this is through the increased use of technology, and the only way to achieve that is through automation. In this age of cut-throat competition, flexibility and efficiency are the keys to quickly develop and produce an increasing number of products to meet the rapidly changing demands of the market.

"Since the automation sector comprises fairly large and mature companies with highly technical processes, this reflects on the manpower needs as well," says Vishal Dahiya, factory automation, Panasonic India.

Complex industrial automation control systems are already installed or being installed across industries. There is a need to understand and acquire knowledge of these systems to

keep the productivity and profitability high, reduce downtime of machines and troubleshoot the systems faster. So practical, industry-focused training on various industrial automation systems like programmable logic controllers (PLCs), SCADA, HMI, drives, PLC networking, process instrumentation and panel designing can be of huge value.

The semiconductor industry—driven by the networking (wireless, broadband), optoelectronics and personal computing requirements—has also showed a whopping growth in recent times. Candidates joining this industry would be expected to have technical skills in the areas of embedded systems, microcontrollers, VLSI, designing and sometimes in the niche areas like digital signal processing (DSP).

"We do see a gap in such areas as VLSI design and embedded system software. In particular, getting people for analogue design is a challenge. From an application's perspective, knowledge of DSP, image processing, graphics, video/audio/speech processing and communication network protocols is invaluable for those who will work on front-end design and embedded software," explains C.P. Ravikumar, director-university relation, Texas Instruments (TI).

SMT is another area with a huge manpower requirement. The electronics industry is facing a tectonic shift from through-hole soldering to SMT with each passing day.

N. Chandramohan, country head (SMT division), Juki, predicts, "With the steady growth of the SMT industry each year, inevitably, the demand of trained manpower will also increase."

Unfortunately, none of the undergraduate electronics engineering

We do see a gap in such areas as VLSI design and embedded systems software

—C.P. Ravikumar, director-university relation, Texas Instruments

